

# Francisco Rau

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Chelsea — Recruitment

Re: Recruitment Analyst

Tilburg, 19 August 2026

I build recruitment analytics for my own research platform, and I would like to do it for Chelsea. transfer-alpha is a player-valuation system I built end to end: 163 competitions, 44,000+ player-seasons, a fair-value model whose gap to market price is the scouting signal, and calibrated 12-month probabilities that a player's value rises, falls, or rises by half again. It is validated the way a club would have to trust it - rolling out-of-sample, AUC 0.87-0.90, Brier skill +0.33 to +0.48, with reliability curves rather than a single headline accuracy.

The part I would most want to talk about is the audit. An earlier version of my transfer backtest reported roughly three times the performance it should have. I found two causes myself: fees were being divided by a price dated a year before the pick, and calendar-year leagues were being stamped mid-season so the ranking used matches that had not been played. Rebuilt honestly, the result is narrower and more useful: shortlisted players were sold at 49.7% versus 30.2% for the pool, but sale multiples were 1.11x versus 1.06x. The edge is in identifying who moves, not in selling higher - and saying so is worth more to a recruitment desk than a flattering number.

Professionally I am a data analyst: at Netvice I built the operational analytics environment from scratch, including a forecasting model that planned capacity 500+ days ahead and a percentile-based index that made individuals comparable across very different workloads - the same normalise-then-rank problem as comparing players across leagues of unequal strength. I hold an MSc in Data Science and a BSc in Economics from Tilburg University.

One practical note, stated plainly: I am a Mexican national currently living in the Netherlands, so this role would require UK visa sponsorship. Everything described above is live and can be demonstrated - I would happily walk your analysts through the model, the calibration, and the audit that changed my own conclusions.

**Francisco Rau**